

# S004 - Catalogue Quality Programme: Project Status

Project Status Report | Operations

|                     |                |                |                       |
|---------------------|----------------|----------------|-----------------------|
| Document ID         | PRJ-S004-002   | Seller ID      | S004                  |
| Department          | Operations     | Classification | CONFIDENTIAL          |
| Owner               | Neha Gupta     | Created Date   | 2026-09-28            |
| Related Scenario ID | SC-006, SC-012 | Document Type  | Project Status Report |

## 1. Status Summary

| Field               | Value                                              |
|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Project name        | S004 Catalogue Quality Programme                   |
| Project code        | PRJ-S004-CQ                                        |
| Triggering events   | SC-006 size chart defect, SC-012 suspension review |
| Reporting period    | 1 September 2026 to 28 September 2026              |
| Overall status      | Green, recovering                                  |
| Operations owner    | Neha Gupta                                         |
| Engineering support | Vikram Singh                                       |
| Seller counterpart  | Karan Mehta                                        |

The size chart defect is fixed, the account suspension has been lifted, and the return rate has returned to near-baseline. Two preventive items remain open.

## 2. Background

On 14 July 2026 a schema update to the dropship feed importer changed how size attributes were read. The UK-to-EU size conversion was applied twice, publishing size charts two sizes smaller than the physical product for a large part of the StrideOne catalogue.

The defect was not detected by any automated control. It surfaced through return data: the return rate rose from a baseline of 9 percent to 27 percent over three weeks, with size-too-small as the dominant reason code. 2,860 returns were recorded in that window.

On 8 September 2026 the automated risk rule suspended the account because the return rate exceeded the 25 percent threshold and a settlement chargeback threshold was breached. The suspension was lifted on 10 September 2026 after review established that the cause was platform-side.

## 3. Return Rate Recovery

| Week ending | Return rate | Note                                     |
|-------------|-------------|------------------------------------------|
| 2026-07-19  | 11 percent  | Defect deployed 14 July, effect emerging |
| 2026-07-26  | 17 percent  | Rising, not yet investigated             |
| 2026-08-02  | 24 percent  | Seller reports pattern                   |
| 2026-08-09  | 27 percent  | Defect identified 5 August               |

| Week ending | Return rate | Note                                                 |
|-------------|-------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| 2026-08-16  | 26 percent  | Fix in progress, returns in flight                   |
| 2026-08-23  | 21 percent  | Corrected charts published 19 August                 |
| 2026-08-30  | 16 percent  | In-flight returns clearing                           |
| 2026-09-06  | 13 percent  | Suspension triggered 8 September on trailing average |
| 2026-09-13  | 11 percent  | Suspension lifted 10 September                       |
| 2026-09-20  | 10 percent  | Approaching baseline                                 |
| 2026-09-27  | 10 percent  | Stable                                               |

The suspension on 8 September is worth understanding: by that date the actual weekly return rate had already fallen to 13 percent. The risk rule evaluated a trailing 30-day average, which still exceeded the threshold because it included the peak weeks. The rule was measuring a problem that had already been fixed.

## 4. Workstreams

| ID   | Workstream                                    | Status      | Target     | Owner        |
|------|-----------------------------------------------|-------------|------------|--------------|
| WS-1 | Correct conversion logic and republish charts | Complete    | 2026-08-19 | Vikram Singh |
| WS-2 | Structural feed validation                    | Complete    | 2026-08-19 | Vikram Singh |
| WS-3 | Customer remediation and exchanges            | Complete    | 2026-09-05 | Neha Gupta   |
| WS-4 | Risk rule recalibration                       | In progress | 2026-10-16 | Neha Gupta   |
| WS-5 | Partner feed contract review                  | Not started | 2026-11-13 | Neha Gupta   |

### 4.1 WS-2 Structural Feed Validation

This is open item OI-2 from the 2025 onboarding project, finally delivered.

The validation is structural rather than per-record, as the original design note required. It compares the distribution of published sizes against the distribution in the partner source. A double conversion shifts the entire distribution, which is detectable even though no individual record looks wrong. The rule rejects a feed whose published size distribution differs from source by more than a configured tolerance.

Back-tested against the July 2026 feed, the rule would have rejected the import on the day the defect was deployed.

### 4.2 WS-3 Customer Remediation

2,860 customers who returned for size reasons in the affected window were offered a free exchange at the corrected size. 1,410 accepted. Reverse logistics cost for the episode was absorbed by the platform rather than charged against the seller's returns reserve, on the basis that the defect was platform-side.

### 4.3 WS-4 Risk Rule Recalibration

Two changes are in progress.

First, the rule will exclude return volume attributable to an open platform-side defect, where such a defect is recorded and linked to the account. This requires a defect-to-account linkage that did not previously exist.

Second, the rule will use a shorter trailing window with a trend component, so a metric that is falling rapidly does not trigger a suspension based on history alone.

4.4 WS-5 Partner Feed Contract Review

The size conversion exists because partners supply sizes in three different conventions. A contract change requiring partners to supply a single convention would remove the transformation entirely. This is being scoped with the four partners for the 2027 contract cycle.

5. Commercial Impact

| Item                                        | Value                              |
|---------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| Returns above baseline, July to September   | approximately 1,950                |
| Reverse logistics cost absorbed by platform | INR 8,70,000                       |
| Suspension duration                         | 2 days                             |
| Estimated lost sales during suspension      | INR 12,80,000                      |
| Settlement reserve adjustment               | Reversed in the 15 September cycle |

6. Seller Position

Karan Mehta was briefed on 6 August, 20 August and 11 September 2026. StrideOne's position is that the account should not carry any commercial consequence from a platform-side defect. Operations agreed this in full: the reverse logistics cost was absorbed, the reserve adjustment was reversed, and the suspension was recorded as a platform-caused event in the account record so that it does not count against future risk assessment.

StrideOne has asked for advance notice before any future feed importer schema change affecting size attributes. This is being incorporated into WS-5.

7. Risks

| ID  | Risk                                                | Severity | Mitigation                                                |
|-----|-----------------------------------------------------|----------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| R-1 | Risk rule recalibration slips past the festive peak | High     | Interim manual review required before any S004 suspension |
| R-2 | Partner schema change before WS-5 completes         | Medium   | WS-2 validation now rejects distribution shifts           |
| R-3 | Return rate rises again for unrelated reasons       | Low      | Weekly monitoring until two months below 12 percent       |

8. Next Period

1. Complete risk rule recalibration by 16 October 2026.
2. Hold interim manual review requirement until R-1 is closed.

3. Open partner feed contract discussions by 13 November 2026.
4. Continue weekly return rate monitoring.